

its capabilities. One thing that catches your eye is the fact that Affinity tracks every little change you make on your file, making the undo feature a lot more reliable than some other software. The software also comes with 16bpc editing, RAW processing, ICC colour management, end-to-end CMYK processing, and cross-compatibility with Photoshop and .psd files, which means the transition from the Industry standard to Affinity is near-seamless. The transition is also made easier with the fact that the UI is very similar to Photoshop's own workspace, so barring a few adaptations on your part, you know where most of the tools are, already.

PhotoPlus X7 software is built on the same foundation as its Mac counterpart. Thus making it the most viable competitor to Adobe Photoshop with respect to usability. It also does so at almost one-tenth the price of Photoshop CS6, which makes it a very good choice for small companies and individuals who are working on a budget. When it comes to features, it's a successor of Affinity Pro, so its features are more refined and tuned. You definitely get the bang for your buck with PhotoPlus X7. The only downside to both these software is the exclusivity to Mac and Windows respectively. But even if you own both PCs, buying a copy of each of these softwares is still a lot cheaper than buying any of the high end software or playing for the Creative Cloud.

Corel Paintshop Pro

Platform: Windows

Price: Rs. 5,500/- (approx.)

It's very understandable for freshers in the photo editing industry to feel confused and mildly intimidated by the professional software out there. The haphazard appearance and the overwhelming rows of tools and icons and rulers can put people in a mild panic attack and a sense of 'what am I doing here.' Corel Paintshop successfully puts all these apprehensions in a box and counters them with ease.

Corel, known for its vector image editing tool got into raster imaging with the Paintshop Pro software. It's a great software for beginners with barely any learning curve - which means that whether you're a professional editor or a perplexed amateur, Paintshop is very intuitive and can appeal to everyone interested in trying their hand in the photo editing business.

The Paintshop Pro UI needs some getting used to, but like everything Corel, tutorials are made easy via videos. Borrowing a page from the Adobe book of success, Corel has dedicated workspaces for the various stages of editing. The workspaces are well-organized and finding the right tool for